And to Think That I Saw It On Mulberry Street

By Theo Geisel (aka Dr. Seuss)

INTRODUCTION

One day Marco sees a horse pulling a man on a broken-down wagon on Mulberry Street. But he soon imagines something much grander. If you change a horse for a zebra, that's better. Or you could change that zebra for a large reindeer. Or better yet, how about an elephant with a Rajah wearing rubies on a throne on top? And on it goes.

Pulitzer-prize winning Dr. Seuss needs no introduction. His ode to the imagination of a child is as fresh and exquisitely outlandish today as it was when first published in 1937. This is a classic that will never fade with age. And to Think That I Saw it On Mulberry Street by Theo Geisel.

When I leave home to walk to school,

Dad always says to me,

"Marco, keep your eyelids up

And see what you can see."

But when I tell him where I've been

And what I think I've seen,

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He looks at me and sternly says,

"Your eyesight's much too keen.

Stop telling such outlandish tales,

Stop turning minnows into whales."

. . . . . .

Now, what can I say

When I get home today?

All the long way to school

And all the way back,

I've looked and I've looked

And I've kept careful track,

But all that I've noticed,

Except my own feet,

Was a horse and a wagon

On Mulberry Street.

That's nothing to tell of,

That won't do of course …

Just a broken-down wagon

That's drawn by a horse.

That can't be my story. That's only a start.

I'll say that a ZEBRA was pulling the cart!

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And that is a story that no one can beat,
When I say that I saw it on Mulberry Street.
-Yes, the zebra is fine, but I think it's a shame,
Such a marvelous beast with a cart that's so tame,
The story would really be better to hear
If the driver I saw were a charioteer.
A gold and blue chariot's something to meet,
Rumbling like thunder down Mulberry Street!
No, it won't do at all … Azebra's too small,
A reindeer is better; he's fast and he's fleet,
And he'd look mighty smart on old Mulberry Street.
Hold on a minute! There's something wrong!
A reindeer hates the way it feels
To pull a thing that runs on wheels,
He'd be much happier, instead, if he could pull a fancy sled.

Hmmmmm … A reindeer and sleigh …
… Say … anyone could think of that, Jack or Fred, or Joe or Nator … say, even Jane could think of that.
But it isn't too late to make one little change,

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A sleigh and an elephant! There's something strange!
—I'll pick one with plenty of power and size,
A blue one with plenty of fun in his eyes.
And then, just to give him a little more tone,
Have a Rajah, with rubies, perched high on a throne.
Say! That makes a story that no one can beat,
When I say that I saw it on Mulberry Street.
But it still could be better. Suppose that I add …
(look at watch)
… Notime for more,
I'm almost home
. . . . . .
I swung around the corner
And dashed through the gate,
I ran up the steps
And I felt simply GREAT!
FOR I HAD A STORY THAT NO ONE COULD BEAT!
AND TO THINK THAT I SAW IT ON MULBERRY STREET!
But Dad said quite calmly,
"Just draw up your stool

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And tell me the sights

On the way home from school."

THERE WAS SO MUCH TO TELL, I JUST COULDN'T

BEGIN!

Dad looked at me sharply and pulled at his chin,

He frowned at me sternly from there in his seat,

"Was there nothing to look at …Nopeople to greet?

Did nothing excite you or make your heart beat?"

"Nothing," I said, growing red as a beet,

"But a plain horse and wagon on Mulberry Street."

SOURCE INFORMATION

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